

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Appointment Reminders · Live Delay Tracker · Optional Pre-Payment

Field	Detail
Document Type	Product Requirements Document (PRD)
Product	SalonBookr (SalonOS B2B SaaS Platform)
Initiative	Appointment No-Show Reduction
Owner	Product Team
Status	Draft for Review
Version	1.0 (synthesized from BRD v2.0 and FRD v2.0)
Source Documents	Business Requirements Document (BRD) v2.0; Functional Requirements Document (FRD) v2.0
Integrations	WhatsApp Business API, Razorpay Payment Gateway

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1. Purpose of This Document

This PRD is the single, product-owned source of truth for the No-Show Reduction Initiative. It sits between the Business Requirements Document (BRD) — which defines the business problem, objectives, and KPIs — and the Functional Requirements Document (FRD) — which defines detailed system behavior for engineering and QA. This document translates "why" into "what we are building and how success is measured," and is the reference used for sprint planning, design review, and go/no-go decisions.

Related documents: Business Requirements Document (BRD) v2.0, Functional Requirements Document (FRD) v2.0, AS-IS/TO-BE Process Flow Diagrams, Wireframes (5 screens), UAT Test Cases, Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM).

2. Problem Statement

Salons on the SalonBookr platform lose approximately 40% of booked appointments to no-shows, across both call-based and online bookings. This is not one problem but three distinct, compounding root causes:

- Customers forget appointments — there is no structured reminder process today.
- Customers are blindsided by salon delays — they have no visibility into running lateness, so they leave, cancel, or simply don't show up.
- Booking carries low commitment — nothing distinguishes a casual booking from a committed one, so customers cancel or no-show with no cost to themselves.

A single delayed appointment also cascades into every appointment scheduled behind it that day, compounding dissatisfaction and further cancellations.

3. Goals and Success Metrics

3.1 Business Objective

Reduce the average appointment no-show rate from 40% to 30% within six months of rollout, while improving appointment utilization and strengthening SalonBookr's value proposition for salon owners.

3.2 Primary KPI

Metric	Formula	Baseline	Target
No-Show Rate	$\text{Missed Appointments} \div \text{Total Appointments} \times 100$	40%	30% within 6 months

3.3 Secondary KPIs

Metric	Target
Reminder Engagement Rate	60%

Metric	Target
Appointment Attendance Rate	+10% increase
Delay Update Delivery Rate	95%
Reschedule-via-Delay Rate (of 60+ min delays)	70%
Pre-Payment Adoption Rate (of eligible bookings)	55%
Priority Service On-Time Rate	90%

3.4 Non-Goals

This initiative explicitly does not aim to: eliminate all no-shows; replace existing salon scheduling workflows; automate employee scheduling; predict future customer attendance; optimize salon pricing; or eliminate salon delays at the source — the platform communicates and manages delay, it does not prevent it. No feature in this release guarantees a zero-delay SLA, including for Priority Service customers.

4. Users and Personas

Actor	Role in This Initiative
Salon Customer	Books appointments; receives reminders and delay updates via WhatsApp; may elect to pre-pay for a discount and priority service
Salon Owner / Staff	Configures reminder, delay-cadence, and pre-payment settings; manages the live appointment calendar; marks appointments Attended/No-Show
Product Team	Owns feature design, delivery, and rollout
Analytics Team	Builds and maintains KPI tracking for no-show rate and related metrics
Sales Team	Communicates new capabilities to prospective and existing salons
Customer Success Team	Onboards salons and provides ongoing support

4.1 Key User Stories

Salon Owner

- As a salon owner, I want customers to receive reminders so that fewer appointments are missed.
- As a salon owner, I want to proactively notify customers when my salon is running behind, so they are not caught off guard.
- As a salon owner, I want to offer a discount and priority service to customers who pre-pay, so more customers commit upfront — without forcing payment on anyone.

Salon Customer

- As a customer, I want appointment reminders so I don't forget my booking.

- As a customer, I want to know in real time how delayed my appointment is running, so I can plan my time.
- As a customer, I want the option to reschedule if the salon is running very late, rather than waiting indefinitely.
- As a customer, I want the choice to pay in advance for a discount and faster service, without being required to.

5. Solution Overview

Three new modules on the SalonOS platform, each targeting a distinct root cause:

Feature	Channel	Solves
Appointment Reminder System	WhatsApp	Customers forgetting appointments
Live Delay Tracker	WhatsApp	Customers blindsided by running salon delays
Pre-Payment (Optional)	Razorpay	Low booking commitment — solved with incentive, not requirement

Scope note: this initiative was originally scoped as a mandatory pre-payment requirement plus a "Waitlist Management" feature for re-filling cancelled slots. Based on revised business direction (v2.0), Waitlist Management was redefined into the Live Delay Tracker — which manages delay on already-booked appointments rather than re-filling cancelled ones — and pre-payment was changed from mandatory to fully elective. This PRD reflects v2.0 scope only.

6. Scope

6.1 In Scope

- WhatsApp appointment confirmation and reminder messages
- Real-time delay calculation and WhatsApp delay status updates
- Razorpay payment gateway integration
- Reminder scheduling logic (24-hour, 2-hour, 1-hour, optional 30-minute)
- Delay-triggered reschedule flow (offered when cumulative delay exceeds 60 minutes)
- Optional, customer-elective pre-payment collection and payment status tracking
- Pre-payment discount configuration and calculation
- Priority Service tagging and delay-minimization logic for pre-paid customers

6.2 Out of Scope

- SMS or email-based reminders
- Loyalty or rewards programs
- Dynamic or demand-based pricing

- AI-based no-show prediction or demand forecasting
- Payment gateways other than Razorpay
- Automated refund processing
- Post-appointment review or feedback collection
- Guaranteed zero-delay SLA for any customer, including Priority Service customers
- Stacking pre-payment discounts with other promotions or loyalty offers
- Mandatory pre-payment requirements of any kind

7. Feature 1 — Appointment Reminder System

7.1 Objective

Reduce no-shows caused by customers forgetting their appointments by sending a structured sequence of WhatsApp messages from booking through the appointment window.

7.2 Reminder Schedule

Trigger Point	Message Type	Default State
Immediately after booking	Booking Confirmation	Always on
24 hours before appointment	Reminder 1	Always on
2 hours before appointment	Reminder 2	Always on
1 hour before appointment	Reminder 3	Always on
30 minutes before appointment	Reminder 4 (Optional)	Off by default — salon opts in

7.3 Requirements

- Send booking confirmation via WhatsApp within 60 seconds of appointment creation.
- Trigger Reminder 1 exactly 24 hours before the scheduled time; Reminder 2 at 2 hours; Reminder 3 at 1 hour.
- Allow salons to enable an optional Reminder 4 at 30 minutes before, from salon settings.
- If booked less than 24 hours out, skip reminders whose window has passed and send only remaining applicable ones.
- On reschedule, cancel pending reminders for the original time and schedule new ones against the updated time.
- On cancellation, cancel all pending reminders immediately.
- Each message includes customer name, salon name, service booked, date, time, a Reschedule action, and a Cancel action.
- Retry failed WhatsApp deliveries up to 2 times over 10 minutes, then log the failure for analytics.

- Where a reminder trigger coincides with a Live Delay Tracker trigger, merge into a single message (Section 9).

7.4 Acceptance Criteria

- Given a new booking, when confirmed, then a confirmation message is sent within 60 seconds.
- Given an appointment 24+ hours out, when each trigger window is reached, then the corresponding reminder is sent.
- Given the 30-minute reminder is not enabled, when that window is reached, then no message is sent.
- Given a customer cancels via a reminder, when processed, then all remaining reminders are removed from the queue.
- Given a booking made less than 24 hours out, when confirmed, then only reminders whose window has not passed are scheduled.

8. Feature 2 — Live Delay Tracker

Note: originally scoped as “Waitlist Management” (slot recovery for cancellations); redefined in v2.0 to address running delays during the appointment day, a distinct root cause.

8.1 Objective

Reduce customer frustration and last-minute cancellations caused by salons running behind schedule, by proactively communicating real-time delay status and offering a reschedule option once delays become significant.

8.2 Delay Notification Cadence

Window	Update Frequency	Status
2 hours to 1 hour before appointment	Every 30 minutes	Always on
1 hour before appointment to appointment time	Every 15 minutes	Always on
Cumulative delay exceeds 60 minutes (any point)	Reschedule option appended to next update	Always on

Cadence and the 60-minute reschedule threshold are configurable per salon; the values above are platform defaults.

8.3 Requirements

- Calculate a running delay estimate per upcoming appointment, based on real-time progress of earlier appointments for the same staff member that day.
- Allow salons to enable/disable the tracker and configure cadence and reschedule threshold in SalonOS settings.

- From 2 hours before the appointment, send a delay status update every 30 minutes; from 1 hour before, every 15 minutes.
- State the current estimated delay in plain language (e.g. “Running approximately 15 minutes late”).
- If cumulative delay exceeds 60 minutes past the original scheduled time, include a reschedule option in that and all subsequent updates.
- If the customer accepts reschedule, route to a new slot and release the original slot back to the calendar.
- If the customer declines or doesn't respond, continue updates at the configured cadence until seen.
- If booked less than 2 hours out, begin delay tracking immediately at whichever cadence applies.
- Stop delay tracking once the customer is marked Attended, Cancelled, or Rescheduled.
- Merge with coinciding Reminder System triggers into a single message (Section 9).

8.4 State Transitions — Delay Status

State	Trigger	Next State
On Schedule (No Delay)	Real-time check shows salon on schedule	Minor Delay, if delay begins accumulating
Minor Delay (1–29 min)	Cumulative delay enters this band	Moderate Delay, or back to On Schedule
Moderate Delay (30–59 min)	Cumulative delay enters this band	Major Delay, or back to Minor/On Schedule
Major Delay (60+ min)	Cumulative delay crosses 60-min threshold	Rescheduled (accepted) or remains Major Delay
Resolved	Customer marked Attended	Closed — tracking stops

8.5 Acceptance Criteria

- Given an appointment is 2 hours out, when that mark is reached, then a delay status update reflecting current schedule status is sent.
- Given updates are every 30 minutes, when the 1-hour mark is reached, then frequency increases to every 15 minutes.
- Given cumulative delay exceeds 60 minutes, when the next update is generated, then a reschedule option is included.
- Given a customer accepts reschedule, when they select a new slot, then the original slot is released back to the calendar.
- Given an appointment is marked Attended, when the next check would occur, then no further updates are sent.
- Given the salon's schedule recovers, when the next check runs, then delay status returns to “No delay.”

9. Feature 3 — Pre-Payment System (Optional)

9.1 Objective

Increase customer commitment and reduce casual, low-intent bookings by rewarding customers who voluntarily pre-pay with a percentage discount and priority service. Pre-payment is never required to book.

9.2 Requirements

- Salons can enable pre-payment as an elective option for some or all services.
- Customers choose, at booking, whether to pre-pay (full or partial, per salon config) or proceed with standard no-payment booking.
- Payment is processed exclusively through Razorpay.
- On successful payment: confirm the appointment at the discounted total, tag it Priority Service, store the payment record, and trigger the Reminder System.
- On failed payment: no appointment is created under the pre-payment path; prompt the customer to retry or switch to standard booking.
- Store all payment records (amount, discount, status, transaction ID, timestamp) linked to the appointment.
- Send a WhatsApp payment receipt on successful transaction.
- Hold a payment-pending slot for a configurable window (default 10 minutes); release it if payment is not completed in time.
- Allow salons to configure a discount percentage per service.
- Display original price, discount %, discount amount, and final payable amount before payment.
- Tag successful pre-paying customers Priority Service in the Scheduling Engine.
- Prioritize on-time service for Priority Service customers ahead of non-prepaid customers wherever staffing allows.
- Give Priority Service customers a single reassurance message in place of the standard escalating delay cadence, unless an actual delay materializes — in which case standard Feature 2 updates resume.

9.3 Payment Status Values

Status	Description
Pending	Payment initiated via Razorpay but not yet completed; slot held temporarily
Successful	Payment completed; appointment confirmed at discounted total, Priority Service tagged, reminders triggered
Failed	Payment attempt unsuccessful; no appointment created under the pre-payment path; slot released
Expired	Payment window elapsed without completion; slot released
Not Applicable	Customer chose standard no-payment booking; appointment confirmed without discount or Priority Service tag

9.4 Acceptance Criteria

- Given a customer reaches checkout for a pre-payment-enabled service, when the choice is presented, then both “Pre-pay” and “Book without payment” are available.
- Given a service has a configured discount, when the customer selects pre-pay, then the discounted total is displayed before payment.
- Given pre-payment completes successfully, when confirmed, then the customer is tagged Priority Service and receives the modified Delay Tracker experience.
- Given pre-payment succeeds, when confirmed, then a payment record is stored and a WhatsApp receipt is sent.
- Given pre-payment fails, when the failure is returned, then no appointment record is created and the customer is prompted to retry or switch to standard booking.
- Given a payment is left pending beyond the hold window, when the window expires, then the slot is released.

10. Cross-Feature Business Rules

- Where a Reminder System trigger and a Delay Tracker trigger fall at the same point in time (2-hour and 1-hour marks), merge them into a single WhatsApp message to avoid duplicate notifications.
- Pre-paid customers are flagged Priority Service; the Delay Tracker applies a modified, reduced-urgency messaging pattern unless an actual delay materializes.
- If a Priority Service customer's delay nonetheless exceeds the 60-minute threshold, the standard reschedule flow applies in full, and any pre-payment discount already applied is honored on the rescheduled booking.
- Rescheduling — whether customer- or delay-initiated — does not require repayment if pre-payment was already collected, unless the new slot maps to a different priced service.
- All reminder, delay, and payment events are logged with timestamps to support analytics tracking.

11. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Reliability	Reminder and delay update triggers must fire within ± 2 minutes of their scheduled time
Availability	WhatsApp and Razorpay integrations should degrade gracefully; failures must be logged, not silently dropped
Accuracy	Delay estimates should reflect the salon's actual real-time schedule status within a target margin of ± 5 minutes
Data Integrity	Payment and appointment state must remain consistent even if the Razorpay callback is delayed
Auditability	Every reminder, delay update, and payment transaction must be traceable for analytics and support

Category	Requirement
Configurability	Salon-level settings (30-min reminder, delay cadence, reschedule threshold, discount %, hold windows) must be editable without engineering involvement

12. Dependencies and Assumptions

12.1 Dependencies

- WhatsApp Business API integration
- Razorpay payment gateway integration
- Existing appointment scheduling / calendar module
- Real-time appointment status tracking (start/completion timestamps) to support live delay calculation
- Customer CRM database
- Analytics tracking infrastructure

12.2 Assumptions

- Salons have an active WhatsApp Business integration configured on SalonBookr.
- Customers provide valid, reachable phone numbers at booking.
- Razorpay services remain available and operational.
- Customers are willing to engage with salons via WhatsApp.
- Salons configure pre-payment discount and priority-service settings correctly for the services they enable.
- Salons maintain reasonably accurate real-time appointment status so delay calculations reflect actual conditions.

13. Risks

Risk	Business Impact
Customers ignore reminder or delay messages	Reduced effectiveness of reminder and delay-tracking features
WhatsApp message delivery failures	Customers miss notifications entirely
Payment gateway downtime	Customers unable to complete pre-payment when they choose to
Inaccurate real-time delay estimates	Customer mistrust of delay updates; reputational risk
Discount used without genuine commitment (pre-pay then frequently reschedule)	Margin erosion without the intended reduction in no-shows

Risk	Business Impact
Salon staff unable to honor Priority Service commitments	Pre-paid customers experience delays despite paying for priority, damaging trust
Salon staff resistance to adoption	Reduced feature utilization and weaker impact on no-show rate

14. Release Readiness Checklist

Product Team

- Feature development completed
- UAT completed
- Production deployment completed

Analytics Team

- KPI dashboards created
- No-show rate tracking implemented
- Delay tracking implemented
- Payment conversion tracking implemented
- Discount redemption tracking implemented

Sales Team

- Feature training completed
- Feature documentation distributed
- Sales enablement materials updated

Customer Success Team

- Salon onboarding guide updated
- Support FAQs prepared
- Escalation workflows documented

15. Open Questions

- How should the system estimate real-time delay for a salon that does not consistently mark appointments as started or completed?
- Should the discount percentage be a single salon-wide setting, or configurable per service?
- Should partial pre-payments be refundable if a salon (rather than the customer) cancels the appointment?
- Should the 24-hour reminder be suppressible for repeat customers with a strong attendance history?

- If a Priority Service customer accepts a reschedule to a different service tier, how is the original discount re-applied?
- What is the fallback communication channel, if any, if a customer's WhatsApp number is invalid or unreachable?

16. Expected Business Outcome

- Reduce the average no-show rate from 40% to 30% within six months.
- Improve overall appointment attendance.
- Reduce customer dissatisfaction caused by unexplained delays.
- Convert potential walk-outs into reschedules rather than lost revenue and lost goodwill.
- Increase pre-payment adoption through discount and priority-service incentives, without forcing payment on any customer.
- Improve customer satisfaction through better scheduling predictability and transparency.
- Strengthen SalonBookr's value proposition for salon owners as a complete SalonOS platform.